GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF PROJECT DOCUMENTS FOR THE 15TH TRANCHE OF THE DEVELOPMENT ACCOUNT

Summary of updates:

(a) More streamlined results oriented and flexible project design process: The design and quality assurance of concept notes and projects documents is time consuming. It is a lengthy process that is initiated nearly two years prior to the actual start of the project implementation. In order to streamline this process, the main focus of the DA Team quality assurance process will be on project documents. There will be four main components to this streamlined design process:

- A shortened concept note (for future tranches), similar to the description of the project in the budget fascicle. The shortened concept note will, however, include a few additional key elements to facilitate selection of projects to be included in the fascicle. (Further guidance on the shortened concept note will be provided in the forthcoming concept note guidelines for the next tranche of DA projects).
- A shortened project document. While the project document should, as per the current project document guidelines, include all the main elements of previous project documents, **it should be no longer than a maximum of 25 pages in length**.
- A country-specific output/activity workplan and country-specific indicators should be submitted as part of the first Annual Project Progress Report, following consultations with stakeholders in the target countries during the first year of project implementation. (See also section 5.1 Proactive Monitoring of the current guidelines).
- Amendments to the project document as part of the second and third Annual Project Progress Reports - project outputs/activities can be further adapted during the course of the project's implementation to ensure the most efficient and effective use of the funds to achieve concrete results based on demand from countries.

(b) Application of the streamlined process to the current projects: The information available for each project in the fascicle should be similar in the project document. The title, objective and total budget need to stay the same as what is in the fascicle. As the concept notes were written last year and often quickly without consultations with the partners, the information used from the concept note can be changed based on the current situation, country demand, and consultations with partners.

(c) E-learning as an integral part of the project delivery: The COVID pandemic has clearly shown that projects can deliver remotely and deliver well. It will be important to include e-learning in most training activities. Guidance on e-learning can be found in the e-learning section (section 4.4) of this document.

(d) Country demand and determination of target countries: It is essential that all target countries be determined when the project document is prepared. The country selection should be based on demand to achieve concrete results at the end of the project.

(e) Baseline data for indicators: The logical framework now includes a required baseline and target for all indicators.

(f) IPMR and timelines: It is very important that project documents be submitted to the DA Team in a timely manner to ensure sufficient time to enter the project in IPMR. This is required to allow early allocation of funds and so project implementation can start in early 2023. When setting up the project in IPMR or Umoja, it should be ensured that expenditure is tracked at the level of object class.

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INTRODUCTION

These guidelines are not intended to provide comprehensive instructions for developing a project, but rather aim at supporting the expansion of the concept notes into full-fledged project documents, drawing on lessons learned from past Development Account (DA) programming experiences.

In order to expedite the review process and allotment of funds, entities are required to have project documents undergo a thorough internal quality assurance process prior to the submission to the DA Team by 1 September 2022. Following submission of the project document to the DA Team by the DA Focal Point, it will be reviewed to ensure adherence with these guidelines. It is expected that the DA Team will send one to two rounds of comments to DA Focal Points prior to presenting the project document to the DA Quality Assurance Group (QAG). It is planned to have all 15th tranche projects **reviewed and approved by the Quality Assurance Group by the end of November 2022.**

All 15th tranche projects will be required to utilize the Integrated Planning, Management and Reporting (IPMR) solution. Please see the annexed, DA-specific guidance on the utilization of IPMR for more information. It is very important that project documents be submitted to the DA Team by 1 September 2022 to ensure sufficient time to create and populate the projects in IPMR. This is needed to allow timely allocations.

Following approval of the fascicle in late December 2022 by the General Assembly (GA), all allotments should be completed by the first quarter (Q1) of 2023. **Projects not allotted by end of March 2023 will be cancelled, and the funds will be programmed for other projects.**

It is recommended that projects be **planned with an implementation period of Q1/2023 - Q2/2026** in mind, so as to allow 6 months to properly close the projects and prepare the final report, as well as to start preparing for the evaluation, if the projects are selected for evaluation (the selection of projects for evaluation will take place in Q1 2025). Project evaluations for projects selected for evaluation should be finalized within a timeframe of six months after the closure of the project, i.e., by the end of June 2027.

TIMELINE FOR T15 ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITIES	TIMELINE
Preparation of project documents by lead entity and other UN DA implementing entities.	**July – 1 September**
Submission of project documents by the DA Focal Point to DA Team	**1 September**
Review of project documents by DA Team and DA QAG to ensure adherence to DA project document guidelines.	**September - November**
Entering of project data into IPMR.	**November-December**
Decision by General Assembly on the approval of the Proposed Programme Budget including the 15th tranche.	**Late December**

Creation of project allocations following clearance by DA QAG. Projects that have not been cleared by the end of March 2023 will be cancelled and the funds programmed for other projects.	**Q1 2023**
Submission of annual project progress reports (PR) to the DA team	**PR1: 31 January 2024** **PR2: 31 January 2025** **PR3: 31 January 2026**
Selection of projects to be evaluated (a project with a budget of USD 1 million or more is required to be evaluated)	Q1 2025
Operational and financial closing of project	Projects should aim to complete their activities **by June 2026** and have all financial transactions completed by **December 2026.**
Submission of final reports to the DA Team	**End of March 2027** (3 months after project completion)
Submission of evaluation reports (where required) to the DA Team	**End of June 2027** (6 months after project completion)

OUTLINE OF A PROJECT DOCUMENT AND GUIDANCE ON HOW TO PREPARE IT

The following section provides an **annotated template** for the project document, including guidance on how to complete each section. However, **when preparing the project document, please use the clean project document template** shared along with these guidelines and available on the *DA website*. While ensuring that the document captures all the requested information, please be as concise as possible, with a **maximum document length of 25 pages**.

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The executive summary provides a brief overview of the project, following the template below.

Project Code and Title:	2326_ *(e.g. 2326G, as per the budget fascicle)*
Budget:	*$ As per the budget fascicle*
Target countries:	*Please list confirmed target countries.* ***A finalized list of target countries is expected to be confirmed in the project document.*** *Target countries are the main countries that benefit from the project and in which capacity development outputs are carried out at the national level. Any changes to the target countries after the finalization of the project document need to be fully explained in the first progress report.*

Lead Entity:	
Other UN DA Implementing Entities	
Other Collaborating Entities:	*Please list all other partner entities in the UN system, UN Country Teams and Resident Coordinators. This can also include Bretton Woods and other regional international financial and other organizations. All projects are expected to include cooperation with Resident Coordinators.*

Brief description:

This section should not exceed half a page and is expected to cover key project information, including the main elements of the project's strategy, the underlying context and the problem that it attempts to address, the main entities involved in the project's implementation and the planned results of the project.

2. DEMAND, CONTEXT AND ANALYSIS

2.1 Country demand and target countries

This section should highlight the rationale for country selection based on a demand-driven approach. A valid rationale must clearly spell out both the state of affairs and the country's interest to address an issue rather than point out the intergovernmental mandate for the UN to do work in a specific area. **Please note that the selection of target countries should be finalized in the project document to allow ample time for implementation.** If there are changes to the target countries after the project document, this should be specified in the first annual project progress report, with a strong justification. Changes to the target countries should not be made after that point. Please address the following questions:

2.1.1 What **criteria and methodology** has been and/or will be used to select the target countries? Potential for country level impact should be a key criterion, and countries with special needs (LDCs, LLDCs, and SIDS) should be prioritized when appropriate. Where projects plan to work in multiple regions, please provide an explanation of the benefits of the inter-regional approach.

0.0.2 **List the target countries**. Target countries are the main countries benefiting from the project and in which capacity development support will be provided at the national level. This should not include countries that only benefit in a broader sense, such as through regional knowledge dissemination at the end of a project. Lessons learned from past evaluations suggest focusing on fewer countries to allow more focused support and deeper impact. It is thus recommended that this number be kept to between 4-6 countries. For projects with smaller budgets, fewer countries may be preferred in order to maximize the capacity development in each country. Should the project target a higher number of countries, an explanation elaborating on the reasons behind this approach should be provided.

0.0.3 Have the target countries clearly stated interest in and/or a **demand** for the project? **Please elaborate on explicit requests for assistance received from each country**.

0.0.4 Please note that some projects also include beneficiary countries, which are countries that benefit in a wider sense, such as through a regional workshop, but do not have in-depth, national capacity development support in the countries themselves. We are not focusing on beneficiary countries at this stage, but they can be defined in the final report.

2.2 Context and situation analysis

This section should establish the context of the project, provide a brief background on the topic that is the focus of the project, and outline the principal problem and the underlying issues that the project attempts to address. This section should also briefly describe the trigger for the project (e.g. a new resolution/outcome document, etc. calling for this action/project, increasingly requested from Member States; or other recent developments) and should analyze the problems from the target countries' perspective, incorporating a gender-sensitive, human rights-based approach that ensures disability inclusion throughout the project's design.

Please address the following questions:

What is the broader context of the project and the topic that is the focus of the project?

What is the **main problem** in the target countries that the project seeks to address?
What are the **underlying issues** contributing to this problem? What are the hierarchical relationships and inter-dependencies between them?
How does the issue affect women and men, boys and girls? Are there groups of people such as youth, persons with disabilities, older people, refugees, migrants, the poor, etc. who might be **more vulnerable, disproportionately affected, or considered 'left behind'** in terms of the issue? Please briefly elaborate on how and why these groups are differently affected. **Use the strategy section (section 3.1) to elaborate on how their concerns can and will be addressed and integrate this into the results framework whenever possible.**

While the implementation of the project may be based on a country, sub-regional, regional, inter-regional or global approach, the problem analysis should refer to the challenges faced at a **country level**. The problem identified in this section should not consist of a very broad issue, such as poverty, nor should it consist of a description of a mandate or a given inter-governmental process. In many cases, it may not be feasible for the project to address all the underlying issues identified. Please, therefore, be specific about which underlying issues the project is targeting by clearly connecting the targeted issues to the project's results framework and activities (section 3.2) to explain the situation on the ground in target countries before the project's implementation and the expected situation after the project's implementation. In this connection, please also keep the duration and resources available to the project in mind.

2.3 Country level situation analysis

This section can be completed in one of two ways—a representative country-level situation analysis or a specific country-level situation analysis—depending on the current level of engagement with target countries. If a representative country-level situation analysis is chosen when completing the project document, then a specific country-level situation analysis will be required in the first progress report. If a specific county-level situation analysis is completed in the project document, it will not be required in the progress report unless there are important changes that should be captured (e.g. a new target country).

Option 1: Specific country-level situation analysis

Once the key issues have been presented, this section analyzes the issues country by country. This section should give a clearer picture of the status of affairs in each target country and the realistic outcomes sought using the headings below. Building on the broader situation analysis, this section should take into consideration any country-level specificities in how the issue affects women and men, boys and girls, as well as groups of people such as youth, persons with disabilities, older people, refugees, migrants, the poor, etc. Please briefly elaborate on how and why these groups are differently affected. If more than 6 target countries are identified, select 2-3 sample countries to illustrate the current status of affairs and expected country level outcomes. If a target country has completed a Voluntary National Review (VNR) and the review includes relevant information for the project, then that information can also be included in this section (see: https://sustainabledevelopment.un.org/vnrs/).

Country 1 *(replace text with name of target country)*

A. **Status of Affairs**

Explain the status of affairs in the target country. How does the problem identified in section 2.2 play out in the selected country? What progress has already been made or what steps have been taken to address this issue? Within the country, how are women, men, girls and boys affected differently by this issue? Are there ways in which youth, persons with disabilities, older people, refugees, migrants, the poor, etc. risk being left behind? What (if any) support are other UN agencies and other development partners providing to address this issue? What are the principal assets the country has in addressing the issue? What are the principal gaps to be addressed? What does the country VNR say on this issue?

B. **Realistic Outcomes**

What will this project be able to achieve in the country within the timeframe available? What tangible outcomes are foreseen? What is the real expected change for the better in the status of affairs before and after the project? These outcomes should be grounded in the outcomes in the results framework in section 3.2.

Country 2

A. **Status of Affairs**

B. **Realistic Outcomes**

Etc.…

Option 2: Representative country-level situation analysis

Once the key issues have been presented in section 2.2, this section analyzes the issues at the country level. This section should give a clearer picture of the status of affairs in a country that is representative of the target countries (the “representative country”) and the realistic outcome sought. Building on the broader situation analysis, this section should explain how the problem identified in section 2.2 plays out in the representative country, what progress has already been made or what steps have been taken to address the issue in that country, what (if any) support other UN agencies and development partners are providing to address the issue, the principal assets the representative country has to address the issue, and the gaps to be addressed. If the representative country has completed a Voluntary National Review (VNR) and the review includes relevant information for the project, then that information can be added as well (VNRs are available at: https://sustainabledevelopment.un.org/vnrs/). In addition, please explain what the project will be able to achieve in the country within the project’s timeframe, the current status of affairs, the tangible outcomes that are foreseen, and the expected change for the better between the status of affairs before the project and after the project, as would be the case for completing the specific-country level analysis above.

2.4 Stakeholder analysis and capacity assessment

This section is optional. This section should identify all non-UN stakeholders of the project (UN stakeholders will be addressed in section 6), including those who are affected by the problem(s) outlined in the previous sections. In developing this section, DA implementing entities should fill in the table below for each relevant stakeholder. Please list each individual stakeholder or group of stakeholders in a separate row and fill out the corresponding columns. It is suggested that information be provided in generic terms across target countries, unless the information for stakeholder groups varies significantly between countries. If relevant, please include additional lines where there are substantial differences between countries that affect the project's implementation.

Please complete the table below using the following instructions:

Non-UN Stakeholders: Please list non-UN stakeholders in order of their level of involvement in the project. All direct and indirect non-UN stakeholders should be listed here in a separate row (e.g. policymakers, individual ministries, IGOs, NGOs, private sector, academia, etc.).

Type and level of involvement in the project: How does each of the stakeholders relate to the project/problem outlined in the previous sections?

Capacity assets: What are the stakeholder's resources and strengths that can help address the problem that the project aims to solve?

Capacity gaps: What are the stakeholder's needs and vulnerabilities that the project attempts to bridge?

Desired future outcomes: What are the desired outcomes for the stakeholder as a result of the project's implementation?

Incentives: What is the stakeholder's incentive to be involved in the project? How can buy-in be ensured?

Non-UN Stakeholders	Type and level of involvement in the project	Capacity assets	Capacity gaps	Desired future outcomes	Incentives
Stakeholder 1					
Stakeholder 2					

3. PROJECT STRATEGY: OBJECTIVE, OUTCOMES, INDICATORS, OUTPUTS

3.1 Project Strategy

This section should be conceived as the project's **results framework in narrative format.** It should provide a description of the strategy that will be adopted to drive the implementation of the project, considering lessons learned and avoiding duplication of efforts with other organizations/entities both within and outside the UN system. It should explain how the project's expected outcomes will contribute to the project's objective, and how the planned outputs are expected to lead to the expected outcomes. The chronological sequencing of outputs should also be clarified in this section, and it should be explained how each planned output builds on or relates to the other planned outputs. Please be sure to maintain consistency between the information reported here and in the rest of the document (e.g. the logical framework and annexes).

This section should also capture the situation on the ground in target countries before the project's implementation and the expected situation after the project's implementation.

In addition, this section should consider how the project will contribute to **gender equality** and the enhancement of **human rights**, with particular emphasis on **"leaving no one behind"**, taking into consideration how the specific needs of groups such as youth, persons with disabilities, older people, refugees, migrants, the poor, etc. will be addressed. Briefly elaborate on the approaches and mechanisms that the project will employ to promote and advance social inclusion and equality, including between genders, and integrate this into the results framework whenever possible.

3.2 Results Framework

Please note that both the project's title and objective should be the same as the language in the fascicle. **Specific guidance on how to develop outcomes, indicators, means of verification, and outputs can be found in the boxes following the results framework.**

The outcomes and indicators of achievement should apply to the project as a whole, including all target countries, and be used for the ongoing monitoring of the progress towards project-level outcomes and the evaluation at project completion. The first annual project progress report, to be submitted in January 2024, should include country-specific indicators that are used for the monitoring and evaluation of outcome achievements in each target country or sub-group of target countries.

Intervention logic	**Indicators of achievement**	**Means of verification**
Objective *As per the fascicle*		
Outcome - OC1 *The outcomes included in the concept note should be reviewed and, where possible, strengthened. The outcomes (OCs) describe the changes that are expected to occur as a result of the delivery of the planned outputs. The outcomes should be achievable within the project's timeframe and budget and should be specific enough to be measured by the indicators of achievement. In developing the outcomes, it is important to assess whether the completion of the outputs is likely to achieve what is defined in the outcome. Given that Development Account projects have an implementation period of three to four years, it is expected that most projects would contain at least two outcomes, but complex projects with a larger budget may exceptionally have three outcomes.*	**IA 1.1:** **Baseline:** (# or % at beginning of project) **Target:** (# or % at end of project) *The indicators included in the concept note should be reviewed and, where possible, strengthened.* *Please ensure all indicators include clear targets (e.g., X out of Y countries… OR XX% of participants confirm…). See Box 2 for further information regarding indicators.*	*Please answer the following:* *What sources of information will be used to inform the indicator? (Use of multiple data sources for triangulation of findings is encouraged.)* *How and when or how frequently will the data be collected and by whom?*
	IA 1.2: … **Baseline:** **Target:**	*...*
	IA 1.3: … **Baseline:** **Target:**	*...*

<table>
<tr><td colspan="3">Output - OP1.1
Outputs, as derived from the concept note, should be reviewed and can be modified based on the analysis in section 2. Please ensure that the outputs listed are sufficient to plausibly achieve the outcomes proposed, and that they are listed in a chronological order.

It is not sufficient to cut and paste the same output descriptions from the concept note. Each output should be further elaborated upon and provide additional details (at least one paragraph per output) and clearly state what it concretely will entail, who is responsible for it, and what it will lead to.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">OP1.2 …</td></tr>
<tr><td>OC 2
…</td><td>IA 2.1:
Baseline:
Target: …</td><td>…</td></tr>
<tr><td></td><td>IA 2.2
Baseline:
Target: …</td><td>…</td></tr>
<tr><td></td><td>IA 2.3
Baseline:
Target: …</td><td>…</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">OP2.1 …</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">OP2.2 …</td></tr>
</table>

Box 1: Formulating effective outcomes

The outcomes (OCs) describe the changes that are expected to occur as a result of the completion of planned outputs. The outcomes should be achievable within the project's timeframe and budget and should be specific enough to be measured by the associated indicators of achievement. In developing the outcomes, it is important to assess whether the completion of the outputs is likely to achieve what is defined in the outcome. Given that Development Account projects have an implementation period of three to four years, it is expected that most projects would contain at least two outcomes, but complex projects with a larger budget may exceptionally have three outcomes.

Ex:

- *Enhanced technical capacities of selected countries to regularly produce a comprehensive set of environment statistics;*
- *Improved capacity of policymakers in target countries to identify regulatory and institutional gaps in the field of sovereign debt governance;*
- *Improved capacity of public and private stakeholders to identify and select sectors for national production and export of green/sustainable products;*
- *Strengthened national capacity of target countries to develop policies for sustainable housing;*
- *Strengthened capacity of policymakers to formulate cross-sectoral policies that enhance effective participation of youth in economic, social and political life;*
- *Enhanced engagement between policymakers and youth groups in jointly designing, amending and implementing youth-based policies for inclusive and sustainable development.*

Box2: Formulating effective indicators and means of verification

- In the context of DA projects, indicators should provide a measure of the degree of **attainment of the project's outcomes** and *not* a measure of the delivery of the project's outputs. This requires a clear distinction between means and goals. Indicators of achievement assess whether the project is meeting its goal after mobilizing the means (outputs). For example, an indicator that measures attendance at a workshop would not measure the outcome but rather an activity or output. Instead, a stronger indicator would be the development of a national strategy that happened during the workshop.

- As many DA projects are about policy change, indicators that clearly illustrate a move in that direction are recommended. A good way to draft indicators might be to define the specific steps that countries will take to achieve the expected policy change (i.e., action plans endorsed, roadmaps drafted, draft legislation prepared, tools developed in the project used by countries for analytical reports/policy change, etc.).

- Indicators utilizing general terms such as "initiatives", "concepts" or "measures" should be avoided. Indicators should instead use **specific** terminology related to what the project seeks to change (e.g., a regional agreement on…; a draft policy on… etc.). Where the use of general terms is unavoidable, it is recommended that a defining footnote be provided.

- Indicators should be **specific, measurable, attainable, relevant** and **time bound (SMART).**

- Entities are expected to include **benchmarks** for all indicators and ensure that there is a baseline for measurement or assessment of change quantitatively and/or qualitatively, e.g., "X out of Y countries…."

- While **qualitative indicators** are useful, **quantifiable indicators** are preferred as they are more objectively verifiable.

- It is important to be realistic about the **ways in which data will be collected** to inform indicators. Available, feasible and realistic sources of verification should, therefore, be carefully considered while developing the indicators. There is, for instance, no point in developing sophisticated measures for which the process of data gathering would turn out to be excessively costly.

- Indicator selection should take the following into account: **(i)** What data systems are currently in place and can be leveraged? **(ii)** What data can be produced? and **(iii)** What capacity exists to expand current data collection and analysis?

- Use of **multiple data sources** for triangulation of findings is encouraged.

- Project drafters are strongly encouraged to liaise with their Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) colleagues in the evaluation units of their entities to define **realistic, strong and measurable project indicators** that are useful for the external evaluation at the end of the project. Please ensure that indicators can be measured at the end of the project.

- Some examples of strong indicators include:

- *Five National Action Plans (one per target country) for sustainable energy developed and submitted to the respective Governments*

- *A multi-stakeholder platform for guiding implementation of the national sustainable development strategy has been established in four out of five project target countries*

- *Three out of four target countries established national data collection systems on sustainable energy in compliance with the United Nations Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics*

- *Three out of four project countries develop a measurement instrument to monitoring and follow up their digital economy policies*

    - *Each of the selected target cities has endorsed a new participatory urban crime prevention and safety policy*

- *At least three out of the four target cities adopt and implement the City Prosperity Initiative as the local monitoring framework for SDGs urban indicators by 2019*

Means of verification should be the source(s) of data or information that will be used as

Box 3: Formulating effective outputs

The **project's outputs** are the specific set of actions and means that will be undertaken to achieve the project's outcomes. These should focus on achieving high value addition and tangible change with a **strong focus on the national level**. It is useful to consider interventions at different levels (skills, institutions, enabling environment) for increased and sustainable impact. Examples of outputs across capacity development efforts include workshops conducted, toolkits developed, networks established, and advisory services provided.

It is important that the link between the outputs and the outcomes be kept at the forefront during project design. **Successful implementation of the outputs should be sufficient to plausibly achieve the outcomes that they support**.

Entities are encouraged to engage in a thorough **review process** that involves linking the outputs to the relevant outcomes and also the project objective, to ensure soundness and consistency with the overall approach and results framework of the project. In doing so, the following questions should be considered:

Suggested top-down questions:

How can the objective be met? ….by achieving the OC1 and OC2;
How can the OC1 be achieved? …..by delivering OP1.1, OP1.2 and OP1.3;

Suggested bottom-up questions:

If the project delivers OP1.1, OP1.2, and OP1.3 successfully, what will be achieved? … OC1;
If the project achieves OC1 and OC2, will this help in meeting the objective? Yes

In designing the project outputs, entities should give strong consideration to means of ensuring national ownership and assign priority to national processes and institutions. Where possible, means of south-south cooperation should be explored.

3.3 Risks and mitigation actions

Please provide an analysis of the possible risks that may affect the successful implementation of the project and achievement of its expected outcomes and the actions that may be taken to mitigate these risks. The list should focus on **factors beyond the control** of the project management.

Risks *What conditions may hinder the achievement of the project objectives and outcomes?* *Each risk or set of risks should be listed on a separate row. The list should include factors beyond the control of the project management (e.g. Political instability).*	**Likelihood of risks** *The likelihood of the risks to occur (**low, medium or high**)*	**Impact of risks** *The impact on the project if the risks occur (**low, medium or high**)*	**Mitigating Actions** *What will be done to mitigate these risks?*
R1.			**M1.**
R2.			**M2.**
…			**…**

3.4 Sustainability and scaling-up

This section should elaborate on how the project's achievements will be sustained beyond its completion. Sustainability is closely linked to national ownership and should, therefore, represent a **driver of the design of the project** rather than be an ex-post consideration. This section should also seek to address how the capacity development provided through the project will be institutionalized and how best to ensure lasting results, e.g., address potential issues such as high turnover of staff in institutions and the challenges associated with training only a select number of individuals. Furthermore, this section should address the potential for the project to be scaled-up or replicated elsewhere, i.e., multiplier effects, as well as the potential for leveraging additional financial or in-kind funding to further the implementation of the project.

4. KEY ASPECTS

4.1 Mandates, comparative advantages and link to the Programme Budget

List the relevant sub-programmes of your entity as well as of other UN DA implementing entities, as per the 2023 proposed programme budget (there is **no need to provide further details**; use the information provided in the concept note and simply state the titles of the sub-programmes).

State all DA implementing entities' mandates in relation to the project, starting with the lead entity.

4.2 Link to the SDG targets

Please **<u>list</u>** both the number and description of all the essential targets as per concept note (max. of 10).

4.3 Lessons learned

This section should present lessons learned from past or ongoing projects of the implementing entity(ies), partners or other relevant organizations/entities that address(ed) similar issues and which informed the development of this project, including good practices that will be replicated in it . These include the key findings and lessons learned from evaluations, reviews and/or final reports of relevant projects pertaining to the overall project approach/strategy, methodology, partnerships, coordination, country selection, and project management, including monitoring and evaluation. It should be ensured that projects build on existing mechanisms/processes, and incorporate lessons learned.

4.4 E-Learning

For the 15th tranche, all project documents <u>must</u> include at least one e-learning component to be approved. In the context of the DA, e-learning is defined as the dissemination of knowledge and engagement with target audiences through digital modalities, such as, virtual or hybrid workshops, communities of practice and digital self-paced courses, complementing in person modalities of delivery. <u>All projects will undergo a thorough quality assurance process, and project documents will not be approved if no e-learning component is included.</u> A summary of the DA e-learning guidelines are presented below; please see http://www.un.org/development/desa/da/wp-content/uploads/sites/52/2022/06/E-learning-guidelines-Final.docx for the full set of guidelines.

When designing the project, please consider how using digital delivery modalities and e-learning will help achieve the project's outcomes and deliver the project's outputs, by maximizing engagement opportunities with target audiences and optimizing sustainability of support. E-learning should be considered from both the perspective of delivery of activities/outputs as well as from a budget perspective. It is important to ensure that e-learning elements are included early in the planning process and ideally co-created or aligned with the needs and preferences of the target audience, both in terms of technological know-how as well as connectivity constraints, among other considerations. In addition, the environmental impact of project activities should always be considered. By limiting travel, the environmental footprint of a project will be reduced.

When designing a project, please consider the following:

Consider different e-learning modalities and which areas of the project lend themselves to being delivered digitally.

Involve both Information Technology (IT) and capacity development colleagues early in the project conceptualization phase

Utilizing virtual/hybrid means of delivering activities/outputs often has budget implications

E-learning, furthermore, provides an opportunity to reach broader audiences and to address possible issues of inclusion

Prioritize in-person and necessary travel at the local/national level to achieve capacity development and more tangible results on the ground in target countries and to make available funds go further. Regional and global activities can be held virtually or in hybrid way to expand the reach of the knowledge made available.

5. MONITORING AND EVALUATION

In this section, please outline the monitoring plans, and evaluation plans for projects selected for evaluation.

5.1 Proactive Monitoring

This section should explain how and when (at what intervals) data will be gathered against the indicators of achievement in the results framework to assess how the project is performing with regards to its expected outcomes in each target country. For projects that are jointly implemented by two or more DA implementing entities, the section should also describe the process, mechanisms, tools, and roles and responsibilities for collecting, consolidating and maintaining the monitoring data at the project level (as well as at the cluster/workstream level, if applicable). Monitoring data against the indicators of achievement in each target country, and any adjustments that are made based on such monitoring with a view to ensuring timely completion of the project and achievement of its expected results, will be included in the Annual Progress Reports (APRs). Such monitoring data will inform the assessment of results achieved in the terminal evaluation for projects selected for evaluation. The APRs are to be submitted to the DA Team by 31st January every year from 2024 until 2026. Guidelines with further details on the preparation of the APRs will be provided by Q3 2023.

The first APR, due on 31 January 2024, should be used to provide country-specific action plans that have been agreed upon with the countries. If relevant, indicators specific to each target country or sub-group of target countries, to be used to track progress in achieving the expected outcomes in each target country or sub-group of target countries, should be provided in the first APR. Such indicators should guide the delivery of planned outputs specific to the country or sub-group and inform any necessary modifications to ensure the achievement of expected outcomes within the project duration. Country-specific action plans should be developed during the first year of project implementation. Should further changes to the project subsequently be required, including any changes to the target countries, these could be reported on with a full description of the reasons for the changes in the later APR. Should substantial changes be required to the project, then the DA Team should be consulted.

Kindly list the documents and information that will be collected throughout the project implementation, including but not limited to:

- List of workshop participants, including names, gender, email addresses
- Workshop survey results
- Workshop agendas
- Activity report
- Guidelines, methodologies, tools developed by the project
- Publications, research, studies developed by the projects
- Policies created
- Project websites
- List of project focal point and counterparts in target countries, partner organizations and donors.
- Steering committee minutes where relevant
- Information on any supplementary funding (both funding and in-kind)
- Estimates staff time on the project
- User feedback, including but not limited to, feedback on guidelines, advisory services etc.
- User interactions, including number of downloads, number of website visits, demographics of visitors

The documentation should be stored centrally and used for the final report, if the project is selected for evaluation the information should be made available for the evaluator.

5.2 Final Report

The final report provides an **overview of the project implementation and its achievements** and should include monitoring data against the indicators of achievement, collected over the course of project implementation by the project manager. It forms an important input to the project evaluation for those projects that will have an evaluation. A draft of the final report should be made available to the external evaluators of projects selected for evaluation as soon as possible and at the beginning of the evaluation process. Guidelines with further details on the preparation of the final reports will be provided following the financial closure of the project (December 2026). Final reports are to be submitted to the DA Team three months after project completion.

5.3 Evaluation

In accordance with the DA evaluation framework and project evaluation guidelines, a terminal evaluation to be conducted by an external evaluator will be required for half of the 15th tranche projects. The budget for each evaluation will be 4% of the project budget. Projects with a budget of USD 1 million or more will be selected for evaluation, along with a selection of other projects, for a total of at least half of the number of projects in each lead entity. Projects to be evaluated will be selected at midpoint (i.e., at the beginning of 2025) with a view to maximizing the utility of the evaluations in informing future work. Guidance on the selection of projects for evaluation, including criteria to be applied, will be provided in late 2024. Projects that are selected for evaluation will be required to develop, in consultation with the entities’ evaluation units, and submit to the DA Team a tentative evaluation plan, including timelines, budget, the arrangements for the management of the evaluation and the preliminary methodology, in the second quarter of 2025.

For projects selected for evaluation, the evaluation report should be submitted by end June 2027 or six months after project completion.

6. MANAGEMENT, PARTNERSHIP AND COORDINATION AGREEMENTS

A list of all other UN DA implementing entities and other collaborating entities within the UN Secretariat and System should be provided in this section. This can also include Bretton Woods and other regional international financial and other organizations. Please note that project beneficiaries are not considered implementation partners and should, therefore, not be mentioned in this section. This section should also provide a description of **who is responsible for what** and **how the different actors will work together** to achieve the project's objective and intended impact.

The project document **needs to be shared with the other DA implementing entities and other collaborating entities within the UN Secretariat and System** and agreement reached on the roles and responsibilities of each party involved, prior to submitting the project document to the DA Team for review. Please also include budget provisions for DA implementing entities in Annex 3.

Should there **be different divisions** within an entity that will execute the project, then this section should also elaborate on their respective roles.

Coordination and/or implementation mechanisms in the context of the **Resident Coordinator system** and the **UN Country Teams** need to be specified as well as the project's possible connection to the 'United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks'. Please also consult with OHRLLS and OSAA, if relevant.

7. ANNEXES

The annexes should contain additional information regarding the work plan and budget. Please attach other useful and relevant information (e.g. detailed work plans, terms of reference, memoranda of understanding, and implementation agreements) as appropriate.

Below are some general comments on the main budget **classes**. Entities are encouraged to consult with their finance section to ensure budgets correspond to the latest guidance.

1. *<u>Other Staff costs – GTA **(015)**:</u> This budget class is for General Temporary Assistance used to respond to short- term, interim needs of the implementing entity in carrying out the project's activities, through the use of temporary staff resources. Staff charged to GTA are usually located with the implementing entity's HQ office but may occasionally be assigned to a regional center of the entity. GTA should not be used for the recruitment of consultants, or national project staff. As the Development Account does not fund posts, the GTA share of the project budget should be reasonable i.e. max 5%.*

2. *<u>Consultants **(105)**:</u> Consultants should be split into two groups: International consultants, and national/regional consultants. The share of the project budget allocated to international consultancies should be limited. Resource persons in advisory roles, such as panelists at meetings, workshops, seminars, should not be budgeted here but under 'Grants and Contributions'.*

Expert group meeting participants should not be listed in this budget class but rather under Grants and Contributions.

3. *<u>Travel of staff</u> **<u>(115):</u>** This budget class is used exclusively for travel of UN system-wide staff, for all types of travel (participation in expert groups, workshops, providing advisory services). Staff travel costs should not be included under workshops.*

4. *<u>Contractual Services</u> **<u>(120):</u>** Contractual services include institutional contracts with national, regional or international institutions, companies, IGOs or NGOs for preparing publications, conducting studies, carrying out technical work, assisting with the organization of workshops, interpretation costs for Expert Group Meetings, translating or printing documents, etc. The use of local and regional institutions and/or NGOs is encouraged as it contributes to the strengthening of national capacities. This budget class should also be used for procurement contracts.*

5. *<u>General operating expenses</u> **<u>(125):</u>** This budget class should be used for communications and postage costs which can be directly attributed to the project, as well as in-house or low-value printing of reports. For major undertakings related to printing services, use the contractual services budget class.* ***Venue rentals, conference service costs and communication costs associated with workshops/trainings/seminars/ expert group meetings should also be included in this budget class.***

6. *<u>Grants and Contributions – Workshops/ Study Tours</u> **<u>(145):</u>** This budget class is only for costs related to the travel/DSA of participants attending seminars, workshops and study tours as well as travel of experts and/or participants attending Expert Group Meetings. Resource persons not contracted, i.e. meeting participants in advisory roles, such as panelists at meetings/workshops/seminars should also be charged to this budget class. Grants and subcontracts issued to implementing partners to carry out training activities should NOT be charged here but to contractual services.*

Any conference related expenditures including venue rental should generally be charged to general operating expenses.

ANNEX 1: RESULTS-BASED WORK PLAN AND BUDGET DETAILS

Please fill out the table below to provide an implementation work plan and a breakdown of costs, by budget class for each output. The breakdown reflected in Annex 1 should be consistent with the budget requirements reflected in the detailed justification by object code presented in Annex 2. Please include the external evaluation costs in the table below.

Table 1.1 – Breakdown of budget by output and outcome

Outcome	**Output #**	**Budget class and Code** *(Please use the budget classes listed in the table above.)*	**Amount (USD)**

OC1	OP1.1	Other Staff Costs (GTA)	**015**	$ X,XXX
		Consultants	**105**	$ X,XXX
		Travel of Staff	**115**	$ X,XXX
		Contractual Services	**120**	$ X,XXX
		General Operating Expenses	**125**	$ X,XXX
		Grants and Contributions (Workshops/ Study Tours/ EGMs)	**145**	$ X,XXX
	OP1.2	Travel of Staff	**115**	$ X,XXX
		Contractual services	**120**	$ X,XXX
OC 2	OP2.1	…		$ X,XXX …

Table 1.2 – Results based workplan
Please complete the table below by using shading in the relevant cells for each output to show in which year(s) and quarter(s) they will be implemented (see OP1.1 and OP1.2 below as an example).

Outcome	**Output #**	**Expected time to complete outputs**															
		Year 1				Year 2				Year 3				Year 4			
		Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
OC1	OP1.1																
	OP1.2																
	OP1.3																
	OP1.4																
	OP1.5																
OC 2	OP2.1																
	OP2.2																
	OP2.3																
	OP2.4																

Table 1.3 – Planned annual budget expenditure and cumulative financial implementation rate

In order to be able to better track the project's progress, estimates of expenditures to be committed per year should be provided. Please fill out the table below with the annual estimated budget figures by object class, which should derive from table 1.1 above.

Budget Class	**Y1**	**Y2**	**Y3**	**Y4**	**Total**	**%**
Consultants (105)	$ X,XXX	$ X,XXX	$ X,XXX	$ X,XXX	$ X,XXX	**X,XX %**
Travel of staff (115)						
Contractual Services (120)						
General operating expenses (125)						
Grants and contributions (145)						
Other staff costs (15)						
Total project cost						
Cumulative percentage						

ANNEX 2: DETAILED JUSTIFICATION BY CODE

A detailed description of the budgetary requirements by budget class should be developed in this section. For each budget class, details should be provided on the link to the project outputs. When possible, costs and work months should be disaggregated by output.

1. Other staff costs - *GTA* (015) $ (Total)

Temporary assistance to perform the tasks of , in support of outputs: OP#.# (no. of work months) x ($ per work month) = $.

OP#.# (no. of work months) x ($ per work month) = $. OP#.# etc.

2. Consultants (105): $ (Total)

(A separate breakdown by national/regional consultants and international consultants should be provided)

(a) *International consultants*

Total cost of international consultants: $____

Total number of work months for international consultants: _____

[Total # of] International consultants for the task(s) of , in support of outputs: OP#.# (no. of work-months), OP#.#(no. of work-months) and OP#.#. (no. of work months) x ($ per month) = $.

(b) *National consultants*

Total cost of national consultants: $____

Total number of work months for national consultants: _____

_[Total # of]__ National consultants for task(s) of , in support of outputs OP#.# (no. of work-months), OP#.# (no. of work-months) and OP#.#. (no. of work months) x ($ per month) = $.

(c) *Consultant travel*

(Total # of missions) by consultants for the purpose of (if possible indicate countries), in support of outputs OP#.# (# of missions), OP#.# (# of missions), OP#.# (#. of missions), and OP#.# (# of missions). ($ average mission cost) x (total no. of missions) = $

3. <u>Travel of Staff (115)</u>: $ (Total)

(a) *UN Staff from the lead entity*

(No. of missions) by UN staff for the purpose of ( ) (if possible indicate countries), in support of outputs OP#.# (no. of missions), OP#.# (no. of missions), OP#.# (no. of missions), and OP#.# (no. of missions).

($ average mission cost) x (total no. of missions) = $.

(b) *Staff from other UN DA implementing entities and collaborating entities within the UN Secretariat and System partnering on the project*

(No. of missions) by other UN staff for the purpose of ( ) (if possible indicate countries), in support of outputs OP#.# (no. of missions), OP#.# (no. of missions), OP#.# (no. of missions) and OP#.# (no. of missions).

($ average mission cost) x (total no. of missions) = $.

4. <u>Contractual services (120): </u>$ (Total)

A provision of $ is required for services in support of outputs OP#.# : description of services, duration and cost of each contract and if possible recipient country.

5. <u>General operating expenses (125)</u>: $ (Total)

(a) *Communications*

In support of OP#.#, OP#.#, and OP#.#. = $.

(b) *Other general operating expenses*

In support of OP#.#, OP#.#, and OP#.#. = $.

(Conference related costs, including venue rental for trainings/workshops/EGMs should be listed in this budget class)

6. <u>Grants and Contributions (145):</u> $ (Total)

(g) *Workshops, seminars & Expert Group Meetings**

Seminar / Workshop on (title of seminar) in country , in support of OP#.#. Duration of workshop:
_ days; ($ per participant) x (no. of participants) x (no. of workshops) (ideally the number of participants should be a multiple of the number of target countries)

Please include information regarding the length of each workshop/seminars/Expert Group Meetings in number of days.

(h) *Study Tours**

Study tours for the purpose of ( ) in country , in support of OP#.#. Study tour duration:
_ days; ($ per study tour) x (no. of participants) x (no of study tours) = $.
(Ideally the number of participants should be a multiple of the number of target countries)

***Please note that this budget class can NOT cover costs associated with Conference services (interpretation, venue rental etc.). It is only for participant travel cost.**

ANNEX 3: BREAKDOWN OF EXPENSES BY ENTITY AND COST CENTERS

Please provide a breakdown of the expenses by entity, indicating the cost center and functional area for each implementing entity. Kindly include only one cost center and functional area per entity. Once the project is approved and created in IPMR, please share the WBS with the DA Team to allow project allocations.

For joint projects only, please include a breakdown of the budget by object class for each implementing entity.

PROPOSED BUDGET									
Entity	Cost cent er	Functional area	Other Staff costs (15)	Consultants (105)	Travel of staff (115)	Contractual services (120)	General Operating Expenses (125)	Grants (145)	Total Budget
TOTAL									